Beacon Digest -- 2026-10-21

Linux

Critical PHP security update coming

Source: LWN.net

> The PHP security team has let it be known that there is a high-stakes security update coming at 14:00 UTC on October 21. " All PHP users are encouraged to prepare now so they can upgrade as soon as the release is available ". Anybody running a PHP site probably needs to be prepared for this one.

[$] SUSE's efforts to disable setuid system-wide

Source: LWN.net

> Setuid (and setgid) binaries have long been a source of headaches, and security vulnerabilities, on Linux systems. They are largely seen as something to be avoided; SUSE's security team, for example, forbids the inclusion of setuid or setgid binaries in packages unless they have been reviewed and ex...

[$] Discussing a rewrite of XArray

Source: LWN.net

> The work to support block sizes larger than the page size on XFS has been difficult. Many users of XFS run stable kernels, which means that they aren't testing new XFS code as it is released. That has made Daniel Gomez wonder whether adopting Rust for some of the data structures underlying XFS, part...

eMudhra intermediate CA compromise

Source: LWN.net

> Mozilla has announced that it has received a report that private keys associated with eight eMudhra intermediate certificates have been compromised: These keys could allow attackers to issue fraudulent HTTPS certificates for websites they do not control. An attacker who could intercept a user's conn...

OpenBSD 8.0 released

Source: LWN.net

> OpenBSD 8.0 has been released. There are many new features, including the addition of hibernate support for arm64, an increase in the kernel virtual address

> space for amd64 to 512GB, quite a few improvements for the qwx driver that supports Qualcomm WiFi 6 devices, and much more. See the full change...

Security updates for Tuesday

Source: LWN.net

> Security updates have been issued by AlmaLinux (environment-modules, kernel, pcs, perl-URI, python3.14-urllib3, and webkit2gtk3), Debian (python-django), Fedora (bind, bind-dyndb-ldap, chromium, cifs-utils, curl, haveged, python3.15, qt5-qtbase, rust-rbw, rust-routinator, rust-rustls, xorg-x11-serve...

Shared GPUs without shared latency: Priority-aware serving in Red Hat AI

Source: Red Hat Blog

> Chat, batch, and agentic traffic can run on the same graphics processing unit (GPU) without the chatbot waiting for the batch job to complete. Built on llm-d flow control and generally available in Red Hat AI 3.5, priority-aware serving decides which request goes first when the pool is full, and app...

MLOps for edge AI: Managing AI models across distributed fleets

Source: Red Hat Blog

> Deploying AI at the edge is both rewarding and challenging. In previous articles, you've seen how to optimize and package your edge AI models and how to execute them to fulfill common use case requirements at the edge, but there's more.In this article, we'll switch our focus from model and service a...

How Delta Air Lines scaled AI-native development to 1,200 engineers with cloud development environments

Source: Red Hat Blog

> When Delta Air Lines' Developer Experience team started measuring its Net Promoter Score (NPS), they faced a brutal reality: It was very low. Two years later, after deploying cloud development environments (CDEs) to more than 1,200 developers, that same team achieved:NPS improvement.Performance gain...

Crossing the threshold to dependable open source AI serving

Source: Red Hat Blog

> When large open weight models first captured attention, the industry was faced with a challenge. Powerful open models were becoming available, but technologists lacked an open inference serving system that could run them efficiently. Having spent years building inference engines for CPUs, my team an...

Building AI the open source way: Research insights from Red Hat and the Linux Foundation

Source: Red Hat Blog

> The technologies that shape computing don't have to be built behind closed doors. Some of the most important foundations of modern software - from operating systems to cloud infrastructure - have grown through open source, where communities can collaborate, improve the technology, and build on share...

Security

PHP2Shell: Two Unpatched Critical PHP RCE Flaws (CVSS 9.2) Trigger Emergency Security Alert

Source: The Hacker News

> This story is developing and was written before PHP's scheduled 14:00 UTC release on October 21. Once the release is out, the affected and fixed versions below are confirmed by the official advisory. PHP will ship an out-of-cycle security release at 14:00 UTC today, October 21, for two critical vuln...

Attackers Abuse UpdraftCentral Keys to Plant Backdoors on WordPress Sites

Source: The Hacker News

> Unknown threat actors breached TeamUpdraft's website and potentially gained unauthorized access to customers' connection keys for UpdraftCentral, UpdraftVault, and UpdraftClone, using them to backdoor WordPress sites. TeamUpdraft is the developer behind UpdraftPlus, a popular WordPress backup plugin...

U.S. Orders DeepSeek Removed From Federal Civilian Systems, Bans New Purchases

Source: The Hacker News

> U.S. federal civilian agencies must remove DeepSeek products from their information technology systems, along with any third-party products or services "developed using DeepSeek implementations," under a Department of Homeland Security order. They may also no longer buy information technology produc...

State Bank of India Confirms Data Leak After 3,897 Customer Records Found on Dark Web

Source: The Hacker News

> State Bank of India has identified 3,897 customer records containing personal information in a set of about 375,000 records available on the dark web, and it does not yet know where the data came from. The state-owned bank, India's largest, said in a stock-exchange filing dated October 21 that it "h...

CISA Orders Federal Agencies to Patch Exploited Plex2Shell, Siemens, and SiteGuard Flaws

Source: The Hacker News

> The U.S. Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) on Tuesday added four vulnerabilities to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV) catalog, including four vulnerabilities impacting Plex Media Server that's collectively called Plex2Shell. The vulnerabilities are listed below - CVE-20...

Hackers Hid Vasilek Backdoor in VMware Tools During 2-Year Russian Healthcare Intrusion

Source: The Hacker News

> A Belarus-aligned hacktivist group spent nearly two years within the network of a Russian healthcare organization. According to a report published by Russian cybersecurity firm Solar, the activity has been attributed to a threat cluster dubbed Partisan Zmiy, which is also known as the Cyber Partisan...

Eight eMudhra CA Keys Compromised, Triggering Emergency Fixes Across Browsers and Software

Source: The Hacker News

> The private keys of eight eMudhra intermediate certificate authority (CA) certificates are compromised, Mozilla and Google's Chrome Root Program confirms on October 20. An intermediate CA signs the certificates that websites present, so anyone holding one of these keys could issue a certificate for...

Critical FortiSIEM Flaw Gets Public Exploit PoC for Unauthenticated Remote Code Execution

Source: The Hacker News

> Cybersecurity researchers have released a proof-of-concept (PoC) exploit for a recently patched critical security flaw impacting Fortinet FortiSIEM that could result in arbitrary code execution. The vulnerability, tracked as CVE-2026-106173 (CVSS score: 9.4), is a critical path traversal flaw that c...

Qilin and INC Ransomware Groups Exploit Palo Alto Networks Flaw to Bypass MFA

Source: The Hacker News

> Palo Alto Networks has disclosed that it's continuing to observe exploitation of a now-patched security flaw impacting PAN-OS and Prisma Access by ransomware actors. The activity relates to CVE-2026-0257 (CVSS score: 7.8), an authentication bypass flaw that could be exploited by bad actors to set up...

Hackers Use Autonomous AI Agents to Breach Company Websites, Target Over 1,200 Sites

Source: The Hacker News

> A Chinese-speaking criminal pointed autonomous AI agents at company websites and let them break in with almost no help, and a security researcher watched it happen because the operators left their control panels open on the internet. The agents tried more than 1,200 sites and reached websites belong...

Pegasus Spyware Infection Confirmed on Serbian University Rector's iPhone Days Before Election

Source: The Hacker News

> The iPhone of Vladan Đokić, rector of the University of Belgrade and a prominent supporter of Serbia's student protest movement, was infected with NSO Group's Pegasus spyware in 2026, the Citizen Lab said on October 19. The finding came six days before Serbia's October 25 snap parliamentary election...

WhatsApp Hid Instructions in Help Pages Telling Its AI Chatbot Not to Recommend Privacy Regulators

Source: The Hacker News

> WhatsApp's help pages carried hidden instructions for its support chatbot that told it not to recommend a data protection authority or regulator to users who could no longer delete their accounts, even though WhatsApp's own privacy policy for Europe tells users they can complain to one. The text sat...

What Security Teams Can Do To Tame Wild Code

Source: The Hacker News

> A sales manager builds an AI-assisted workflow to route leads. It connects to customer records, summarizes inbound requests, and posts updates to a shared channel. The workflow saves time, reduces manual work, and soon becomes part of the team’s daily routine. Across the same organization, employees...

Go Issues Emergency Update Blocking Eight CA Keys Over Undisclosed Security Concerns

Source: The Hacker News

> Go 1.27.3 and Go 1.26.10, released on October 20, make Go's certificate verifier reject any certificate chain that passes through one of eight intermediate certificate authority keys. Programs built on the new release will refuse connections to sites and services whose certificates were issued under...

Russian APT28 Breaches NATO Naval Shipbuilder in NATO Country, Deploys New Reflective Loader

Source: The Hacker News

> The Russia-linked state-sponsored threat actor tracked as APT28 (aka BlueDelta, Fancy Bear, and Forest Blizzard) has been attributed to attacks targeting two member states of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO). The Symantec Threat Hunter Team, which is tracking the activity cluster under...

ConnectWise Resets Credentials as Cloud Backup Remains Offline After Security Incident

Source: The Hacker News

> ConnectWise on Monday said it has taken remediation measures, including strengthening administrative-access protections and resetting accounts and replacing application credentials, as it continues to respond to a security incident that led to unauthorized access to application identities associated...

Hackers Hijack Five OVHcloud CLI Releases to Distribute Secret-Stealing Malware

Source: The Hacker News

> An attacker used a contributor's GitHub account to replace the download archives on five existing releases of OVHcloud's command-line tool on Monday, October 19. The account had been hijacked, and the new files were a build designed to steal secrets stored on the disk of any machine that runs it, th...

General Tech

Eight Bits of Trust; eMudhra's CA keys cracked in milliseconds

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://scotthelme.co.uk/eight-bits-of-trust-emudhras-ca-keys-cracked-in-milliseconds/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50177916 Points: 17 # Comments: 1

The 1.5°C goal of the Paris Agreement is no longer viable

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://unric.org/en/unep-emissions-gap-report-2026-1-5-degree-overshoot/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50177911 Points: 60 # Comments: 8

Pillowfort Is Closing

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.pillowfort.social/posts/8413273 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50176301 Points: 45 # Comments: 23

Battlezone Online: BZFlag in the Browser

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://github.com/timriker/bzo Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50176298 Points: 30 # Comments: 22

Setting Up SSH Keys on macOS with Touch ID

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://nmattia.com/posts/2026-10-19-setting-up-ssh-keys-touch-id/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50175882 Points: 56 # Comments: 32

Using Claude to reduce the attack surface of code

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.anthropic.com/research/attack-surface-reduction Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50175779 Points: 47 # Comments: 19

C# now beats Rust on WASM size

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://github.com/zion-sati/NetWasm Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50175510 Points: 61 # Comments: 15

In Hilbert space, all things are quantumly possible

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.quantamagazine.org/in-hilbert-space-all-things-are-quantumly-possible-20260826/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50175185 Points: 96 # Comments: 51

The Future of CSS

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.joshwcomeau.com/css/interop-2027/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50175070 Points: 371 # Comments: 146

Good type against all odds

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://unsung.aresluna.org/good-type-against-all-odds/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50175059 Points: 122 # Comments: 12

Muse exposes users' personal and business secrets when they share conversations

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://arstechnica.com/security/2026/10/meta-muse-exposes-users-personal-and-business-secrets-when-they-share-conversations/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50174687 Points: 173 # Comments: 70

The Other Epidemic: Trying to get off benzodiazepines

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> https://web.archive.org/web/20261020230542/https://www.thebe... https://archive.ph/Tb1SZ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50173891 Points: 197 # Comments: 146

Feds suspect ransom negotiator ran ShinyHunters extortion site

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/10/feds-suspect-ransom-negotiator-ran-shinyhunters-extortion-site/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50173487 Points: 202 # Comments: 94

Upcoming critical PHP security release (CVE-2026-109618 / -109619)

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> https://cert.europa.eu/publications/security-advisories/2026... https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50167754 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50172041 Points: 823 # Comments: 325

Show HN: SimCity, but with Permits

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://permit.petercai.com/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50170593 Points: 793 # Comments: 375

What shall I teach my son?

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://stevekrouse.com/ends Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50169707 Points: 399 # Comments: 466

Google open-sources TorchTPU, a native PyTorch back end for TPUs

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://github.com/google-pytorch/torch_tpu Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50169053 Points: 340 # Comments: 73

Voxtral 3

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://mistral.ai/news/voxtral-3/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50168396 Points: 671 # Comments: 167

Sixteen years after Deepwater Horizon, deep sea life shows few signs of recovery

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://e360.yale.edu/digest/deepwater-horizon-deep-sea-recovery Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50168357 Points: 279 # Comments: 158

Ofcom concedes defeat in 4chan case

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://prestonbyrne.com/2026/10/20/ofcom-concedes-defeat/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50167028 Points: 389 # Comments: 304